

# The Boston Globe

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## Workers fired over vaccines get hope

Courts open door to more religious exemption suits

By Shelley Murphy  
GLOBE STAFF

During the early days of the COVID-19 pandemic, Theresa Gabana cared for gravely ill patients at Tufts Medical Center in Boston as an emergency room doctor. But when she refused to get a COVID-19 vaccine, saying it conflicted with her religious beliefs, she was fired.

Massachusetts State Police Sergeant Matthew McDevitt was also fired, with a “dishonorable discharge,” after he refused to get the vaccine and his request to be excused on religious or medical grounds was rejected.

They are among hundreds of workers in Massachusetts who sued their employers in federal and state courts after they were denied religious exemptions from mandatory COVID-19 vaccines.

Now, in a series of recent rulings, federal appeals courts here and across the country have made clear that employees have the right to pursue such lawsuits on religious grounds, even if they have uniquely personal or nontraditional religious beliefs. A number of religious discrimination suits have been filed in federal court. **COVID, Page A10**

‘It sounds like you care more about your politics than the safety of your citizens.’

REP. JOHN MCGUIRE, *Republican of Virginia*

‘If you want to make us safe, pass gun reforms, stop cutting Medicaid, stop cutting cancer research, stop cutting funds for veterans. That is what will make our city safe.’

MAYOR MICHELLE WU, *in response to Republican Rep. Paul Gosar of Arizona*

## On the spot in D.C., Wu hits back

Mayor defends Boston’s immigration policies against Republican attacks



SAUL LOEB/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

**President Trump said he’ll pause tariffs on cars coming into the country from Canada and Mexico for a month. A2. Grocers and customers are bracing for price hikes tied to tariffs, and new housing is likely to face similar effects. D1.**

**Israel’s cutoff of food, fuel, and medicine to Gaza has sent prices soaring** and humanitarian groups into overdrive. **A3.**

**Massachusetts researchers sounded another alarm on bird flu**, saying gaps in surveillance and cuts by the Trump administration threaten to undermine efforts to contain it. **B1.**

Mayor Michelle Wu, shown above at the hearing in Washington, D.C., on Wednesday, received some support at a rally in Boston. **B1.**



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

By Jim Puzzanghera and Emma Platoff

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Midway through a six-hour congressional hearing on immigration enforcement Wednesday, Boston Mayor Michelle Wu faced yet another moment where she had to choose whether to answer a pointed Republican question directly or not.

Wu was one of four Democratic mayors called before the committee. The three others — Eric Adams of New York City, Brandon Johnson of Chicago, and Mike Johnston of Den-

ver — chose not to give the yes or no answer requested by Representative Nancy Mace of South Carolina when she asked, “Is breaking into our country against the law?”

When it was her turn, Wu responded succinctly: “Yes.”

Since her election in 2021, Wu hasn’t often sought out the national stage. But on Wednesday, as she was grilled over and over about one of the nation’s most contentious issues, Wu nonetheless showed she could hold her own when that spotlight shined on her, unafraid to either an-

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## In fully smitten GOP, a competition to be Trump’s bestiest

By Sam Brodey

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Five years ago, while giving his final State of the Union address of his first term, President Trump looked out at the Republican side of the House chamber to see members of a party he led.

Standing at the dais Tuesday night for the first congressional address of his second term, Trump looked out and instead saw members of a party he dominates.

Returning to Congress in the thick of his administration’s dramatic effort to upend the federal government and American foreign policy, Trump was welcomed by Republican lawmakers who gave him an extended standing ovation — replete with shouting, cheering, clapping, and chants of “USA!” —

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## Supreme Court deals president a defeat

By Adam Liptak

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court on Wednesday rejected President Trump’s emergency request to freeze nearly \$2 billion in foreign aid in a closely divided decision indicating that the justices will subject his efforts to reshape the government to close scrutiny.

The court’s brief order was unsigned, which is typical when the justices act on emergency applications. It said only that the trial judge, who had ordered the government to resume payments, “should clarify what obligations the government must fulfill.”

But the ruling represented one of the court’s first moves in response to the flurry of litigation filed in response to Trump’s efforts to slash government spending and take complete control of the executive branch. The vote



FARAH ABDI WARSAMEH/ASSOCIATED PRESS

**The ruling rejecting the freeze may pave the way for foreign aid to flow again.**

was 5-4, with Chief Justice John Roberts and Justice Amy Coney Barrett joining the three liberal members to form a majority.

Although the language of the order was mild, tentative, and not a little confusing, its

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